# GOD'S OWN FURY

**HOW WAYANAD'S HILLS TURNED INTO DEATH TRAPS AMID TORRENTIAL RAINS AND HUMAN NEGLIGENCE. HOW CAN WE AVERT SUCH TRAGEDIES IN THE FUTURE?**

*Graphic by* NILANJAN DAS

## HOW IT HAPPENED

1. **JULY 28-29** Torrential rains batter Wayanad district; rainfall gauge closest to Mundakkai under Meppadi panchayat records 572 mm rain over 48 hours

2. **12.45 AM, JULY 30** Heavy showers trigger a landslide in Vellarimala hills; slush, debris and uprooted trees reach Mundakkai village, 3.5 km downhill, sweeping away almost the entire habitation. The flow of debris from an elevation of 2,000 metres creates a dam-burst kind of situation

3. **4.10 AM:** Another landslide hits Mundakkai, also washing out Chooralmala village 2.6 km further downhill. The bridge connecting the two villages destroyed, hitting rescue operations

4. **5.30 AM:** A dismembered body found on the banks of Chaliyar river at Pothukallu in Malappuram district–about 12 km downstream and 90 km away by road. Later, at least 64 more bodies recovered




